

Lieutenant School Syllabus

Officer Formation Level I

Course purpose. Lieutenant School forms the officer who can be trusted under authority. It is the transition from committed member to dependable officer: a man who can receive mission, execute it faithfully, care for those assigned to him, maintain standards, and represent the Order with humility and steadiness.

Historical Foundation

The historical model for Lieutenant School is the **Under Marshal**, described as responsible for the **footmen and equipment**, making him the clearest junior operational officer in the Templar hierarchy. The wider Templar system emphasized a strong chain of command, codified conduct, obedience, communal life, humility, discipline, and care for the weak.

Course-Wide Learning Objectives

Objective Area	Course-Wide Objective
Templar identity	Explain the origins, mission, and structure of the historical Knights Templar and how those lessons inform your Order today.
Officer responsibility	Describe the role of a Lieutenant as a first-level officer entrusted with readiness, standards, accountability, and care of assigned brothers.
Leadership under authority	Demonstrate the ability to receive direction, execute faithfully, report clearly, and lead without ego.
Character formation	Practice humility, disciplined speech, reliability, self-control, and fraternal care.
Team leadership	Lead a small team, assignment, meeting, or service element effectively.
Promotion readiness	Show evidence of readiness for greater responsibility through conduct, practicum performance, and final board review.

12-Lesson Syllabus Overview

Lesson	Title	Learning Objectives	Assignment	Leadership Outcome
1		Define the purpose of Lieutenant School;	1-page reflection: "Why do I seek	

	The Call to Office	explain why office is service rather than status; identify expectations of a first-level officer.	office, and what must be purified in my motives?"	Sees leadership as stewardship, not promotion.
2	Origins of the Knights Templar	Summarize the founding of the Templars, their mission, and why disciplined structure mattered.	Short presentation or summary sheet on Templar origins and mission.	Articulates identity and mission clearly.
3	The Templar Chain of Command	Explain the historical chain of authority and why unity of command protected order and mission.	Draw and annotate a chain-of-command chart for the historical Templars and your Order.	Understands authority, reporting, and structure.
4	The Under Marshal and the Lieutenant Model	Describe the Under Marshal's relevance to lieutenant-level leadership; connect readiness and execution to office.	2-page comparison: "Under Marshal and Lieutenant—historical parallels and modern application."	Understands the practical nature of lieutenant duty.
5	The Rule: Obedience and Mission	Identify passages on obedience and disciplined conduct; explain why officers must submit to lawful authority.	Guided written response on obedience, mission, and self-will.	Accepts leadership under mission rather than preference.
6	The Rule: Humility, Speech, and Bearing	Apply Templar principles of humility, restraint, and disciplined speech to officer conduct.	7-day self-observation log on speech, correction, listening, and emotional control.	Improves bearing, discretion, and self-command.
7	Care of Brothers and Fraternal Responsibility	Explain the Rule's call to care for the weak, sick, and aging; define Lieutenant responsibility for people.	Interview a senior member and submit a reflection on what real brother-care looks like.	Grows from task-focus into people-focus.
8	Readiness, Stewardship, and Reliability	Understand readiness, accountability, and stewardship of assigned duties or resources.	Build a readiness checklist for a meeting, event, ceremonial duty, or team operation.	Learns preparation, follow-through, and trustworthiness.

9	Leading a Small Team	Practice delegation, clarity, accountability, and follow-up in small-group leadership.	Conduct a supervised team assignment and submit an after-action review.	Can brief, assign, monitor, and complete a team task.
10	Correction, Conflict, and Discipline	Learn how to address problems lawfully and constructively; apply integrity in speech.	Case-study responses to leadership problems involving correction, lateness, or conflict.	Handles minor problems with maturity and justice.
11	Lieutenant as Mentor and Example	Understand how junior officers shape culture by example and consistency.	Mentor a junior member or candidate for one week and submit an observation report.	Functions as a multiplier of standards and culture.
12	Capstone Preparation and Officer Review	Integrate course learning; prepare for practicum, written review, and oral board.	Submit final portfolio: reflections, assignments, readiness plan, and practicum summary.	Demonstrates full readiness for first-level office.

Lesson Details

Lesson 1 — The Call to Office

Focus: Office as service, not status. Establish the difference between rank as honor and office as responsibility.

Leadership emphasis: Stewardship, motives, willingness to serve under discipline.

Assignment: One-page reflection on motives for office.

Lesson 2 — Origins of the Knights Templar

Focus: Founding story, mission, and why disciplined structure mattered from the beginning.

Leadership emphasis: Mission gives meaning to structure.

Assignment: Short presentation or mission summary.

Lesson 3 — The Templar Chain of Command

Focus: Hierarchy from Grand Master through regional and local command.

Leadership emphasis: Lawful authority preserves unity, accountability, and coordinated action.

Assignment: Chain-of-command diagram comparing history and your Order.

Lesson 4 — The Under Marshal and the Lieutenant Model

Focus: Under Marshal as the clearest Templar parallel for lieutenant-level office.

Leadership emphasis: Readiness, supervision, support of mission, dependable execution.

Assignment: Comparison paper on Under Marshal and Lieutenant.

Lesson 5 — The Rule: Obedience and Mission

Focus: Obedience as a core virtue; no officer leads well who resists lawful authority.

Leadership emphasis: Disciplined execution over personal preference.

Assignment: Written response to Rule passages on obedience.

Lesson 6 — The Rule: Humility, Speech, and Bearing

Focus: Humility, restraint, disciplined speech, and emotional maturity.

Leadership emphasis: An officer's tongue can either strengthen order or damage it.

Assignment: 7-day self-observation log.

Lesson 7 — Care of Brothers and Fraternal Responsibility

Focus: Caring for the weak, sick, aging, and struggling members of the brotherhood.

Leadership emphasis: Authority includes moral responsibility for people, not just tasks.

Assignment: Senior-member interview and reflection.

Lesson 8 — Readiness, Stewardship, and Reliability

Focus: Maintaining preparedness, accountability, and stewardship of assigned duties or resources.

Leadership emphasis: Readiness is a moral quality as much as an operational one.

Assignment: Readiness checklist for a real activity.

Lesson 9 — Leading a Small Team

Focus: Briefing, assigning, supervising, and reviewing team performance.

Leadership emphasis: Clarity is charity in leadership.

Assignment: Supervised team assignment and after-action report.

Lesson 10 — Correction, Conflict, and Discipline

Focus: Handling problems directly, lawfully, and calmly without rumor or spite.

Leadership emphasis: Disciplined correction protects both people and order.

Assignment: Case-study response paper.

Lesson 11 — Lieutenant as Mentor and Example

Focus: Junior officers shape culture by example, even when not speaking.

Leadership emphasis: Your life is already part of someone else's formation.

Assignment: One-week mentoring observation report.

Lesson 12 — Capstone Preparation and Officer Review

Focus: Integrating course learning for final practicum and oral board.

Leadership emphasis: Readiness for office must be visible, testable, and defensible.

Assignment: Final portfolio submission.

Required Assignments Summary

Assignment	Purpose
Motive reflection paper	Clarify why the candidate seeks office.
Templar origins summary/presentation	Establish historical identity.
Chain-of-command chart	Understand authority and reporting.
Under Marshal comparison paper	Link the historical role to Lieutenant office.
Rule reflection on obedience	Form mission-centered discipline.
Speech and bearing self-log	Build self-awareness and control.
Brother-care interview reflection	Develop fraternal leadership.
Readiness checklist	Build operational trustworthiness.
Small-team practicum and AAR	Demonstrate applied leadership.
Conflict case-study paper	Practice correction and discipline.
Mentoring report	Build cultural and developmental leadership.
Final portfolio	Integrate all work for board review.

Leadership Outcomes

Leadership Domain	Expected Outcome
Identity	Understands the Templar heritage and the meaning of officer service.
Discipline	Demonstrates punctuality, preparation, self-control, and reliability.
Obedience	Executes direction faithfully and reports responsibly.
Humility	Accepts correction, avoids vanity, and leads without self-importance.
Speech	Communicates clearly, avoids rumor, and handles disagreement with maturity.
Care of brothers	Notices needs, supports weaker members, and treats office as stewardship.
Execution	Can lead a small team or assignment to completion.
Promotion readiness	Shows clear evidence of fitness for continued officer growth.

Final Evaluation

Component	Weight	What is assessed
Attendance and participation	10%	Presence, preparedness, engagement.
Written assignments	20%	Historical understanding, reflection quality, application.
Readiness/stewardship assignment	10%	Preparation, organization, practical judgment.
Small-team practicum	20%	Leadership execution, clarity, accountability, follow-through.
Mentor observation	10%	Bearing, humility, discipline, fraternal conduct.
Final portfolio	10%	Integration and completeness of work.
Oral board / final review	20%	Officer presence, judgment, historical understanding, readiness for office.

Sample Oral Board Questions

- Why does a Templar-inspired officer need history?
- Why is obedience foundational to leadership?
- What distinguishes a Lieutenant from a senior member without office?
- Why is the Under Marshal the best historical parallel for this rank?
- What does it mean for a Lieutenant to care for the brothers?
- Where is your greatest growth area as a future officer?
- How would you respond to lateness, disorder, or poor communication in your team?

Practicum Requirement

The candidate must complete one approved practicum, such as leading a ceremonial team, organizing a service project, running a training segment, coordinating a meeting or officer support function, or managing readiness for an event or formal gathering. The practicum should include supervisor observation and an after-action review.

Promotion Recommendation Standard

A candidate should be recommended only if he completes the course requirements, demonstrates steady conduct, performs competently in practicum, passes the board review, and shows the character expected of a first-level officer.

Historical sources used in drafting this syllabus:

Wikipedia — Knights Templar: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knights_Templar

Medieval Warfare — Templars hierarchy and duties: <https://www.medievalwarfare.info/templars.htm>

Medieval Warfare — Primitive Rule of the Templars: <https://www.medievalwarfare.info/rule.htm>